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Si-ings, by
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Cohen Batted for Shanty Hogan And a Sullivan Left the Ball Park

SHANTY HOGAN died the other day at 61 and his passing recalls a delightful story that had its beginning in 1926, when John McGraw brought Andy Cohen to the New York Giants to play the infield.

James Francis (Shanty) Hogan was a huge man, as Irish as his name. He was heavily addicted to eating, and his ravenous appetite showed up massively around his midsection. He wasn't merely big; his body had gone to pot.

Cohen, who later managed the Dayton Ducks of the Mid-Atlantic league in 1939-40, came to New York as the alleged answer to McGraw's long search for any Jewish player, who the manager believed would be a tremendous drawing card in New York.

(For the same reason, the Yankees, who need boxoffice appeal these days, would like to trade for Mike Epstein, the powerful Baltimore rookie.)

One day the Giants had a rally going, and with a couple of men in scoring position, Hogan, the catcher, was due at the plate. McGraw decided he wanted another hitter and told young Cohen to get a bat.



Cohen

This was in the days before ball parks had loud-speaker systems; when announcements were made by megaphone.

"Cohen batting for Hogan," the announcer shouted.

And, as the story goes, there was a deep-throated roar from a gentleman in the grandstand, who voiced his reaction by suggesting:

"And Sullivan lavin' the ball park."

Whether Andy delivered or not is still an historical mystery. Chances are he didn't. He lasted only three seasons as a Giant.

Cohen, now 62, is a great friend of Bob Howsam, new general manager of the Reds. Andy managed the Denver club when Howsam owned it.

Presently Cohen is in the beer-distributing business in El Paso, and also serves as a consultant to the local club in the Texas league.

Andy has another distinction. In his last job in the big leagues, he was one of Eddie Sawyer's coaches on the Phils. Sawyer managed Philadelphia in 1959 but became upset with the club during spring training of 1960. He managed the Phils on Opening Day, then pulled the quickest runout in history, resigning after that first game of the season.

Owner Bob Carpenter named Cohen his interim manager, while he went looking for Gene Mauch to run his club. Mauch arrived a day later and that was the sum total of Andy's stewardship as a big league manager—one day.

As far as is known, by the way, not a single person named Sullivan, O'Brien, Hogan or Donovan left Connie Mack stadium on the day Cohen managed the Phils.